@empowerfarmers

MINNA 2026

100 FARMERS. ONE SEASON.

LIFE-CHANGING HARVESTS.

Interest-free seeds, fertilizer and training for smallholder farmers in Niger State. No loans. No interest. Just results.

100
Farmers / One Season

3x
Yield Increase

$0
Interest Charged

6mos
Repayment Window

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SECTION 01

THE CHALLENGE

Why smallholder farmers in Nigeria are stuck

Good farmers. Empty bowls.

This does not have to be the story.

Nigeria has millions of skilled smallholder farmers. What they lack is not ability -- it is access. Access to quality seeds. Access to the right fertilizer. Access to cash at the moment planting demands it. Without that access, the season is lost before it begins.

PLANTING WINDOW

Only 6 weeks per season.
Miss it and the year is gone.

INPUT COSTS

Seeds + fertilizer cost over
170,000 Naira upfront.

YIELD GAP

Average yield is 3x below
what the same land can grow.

FOOD INSECURITY

Most households run out
of their own harvest in 4 months.

SECTION 02

WHO WE ARE.

empowerFarmers -- an initiative of the ELP Foundation

@empowerfarmers

An initiative of Empowerment for Local People Foundation
empowerlocals.org

empowerFarmers delivers interest-free agricultural inputs, agronomic training, and evidence-based field support to smallholder farmers in Niger State. We go to the communities -- on the land, with the farmers, every planting season.

Registered NGO: Federal Republic of Nigeria

Focus Area: Smallholder Agriculture

Location: Abuja (HQ) | Minna (Field)

2024 Reach: 11 farmers, 2 communities

2026 Target: 100 farmers, one season

Website: empowerlocals.org

Every farmer gets a full kit.

Before the rains come. Not after.

01

CERTIFIED SEEDS

SC651 hybrid maize seeds

Higher yield, faster maturity, optimised for Minna soil

02

NPK FERTILIZER

Two 25 kg bags per acre

NPK 20-10-10 -- correct basal application rate

03

NEEM COATED UREA

One 50 kg bag

Slow-release urea for top-dressing -- more nitrogen reaches the crop

04

LAGOON HERBICIDE

Full season weed control

Clears the field in the critical first 10 weeks of growth

05

LABOUR CASH GRANT

Cash for land preparation

Farmers clear and plant on time without waiting for credit

06

AGRONOMIC TRAINING

Monthly in-person field visits

Hands-on guidance from planting through to harvest storage

SECTION 03

THE PATIENCE MODEL.

How we work and what makes us different

Patience over pressure.

PATIENT CAPITAL

No interest.

No fees.

No pressure during the growing season.

We wait for the harvest.

You invest. They grow. Then they contribute.

RESEARCH FIRST

We survey every community before a single input is given.

Garatu and Taidna were surveyed April 2026.

We build from evidence, not assumptions.

Funding that waits for the farmer.
Not the other way around.

BEFORE EMPOWERFARMERS

4 bags.

~200 kg | Local saved seed | No fertilizer

WITH EMPOWERFARMERS

8–10 bags.

~500 kg | Certified seeds | NPK + urea | Training

What each farmer gives back:

About 4% of what they grew.

Only at harvest. Not before. This grain funds the next farmer in the community.

A note on measurement:
5 mudus (a traditional calabash) = 5.65 kg = about 4% of an 8-10 bag harvest.
It is small enough to feel nothing. Meaningful enough to fund the next family.

We stay.

Monthly. In person. All season long.

FULL-DAY TRAINING

Before planting. Seeds, fertilizer, herbicide, pest control, storage.

MONTHLY FARM VISITS

Every farm. Every month. In person. No exceptions.

PHOTO UPDATES

Every visit documented. Donors receive monthly field reports.

ENDLINE SURVEY

December. We measure what changed. Yield, income, food security.

The rains come whether you are ready or not.
We make sure you are ready.

SECTION 04

OUR IMPACT

Results, where we work, and 2026 plans

Here is what happened when we gave farmers what they needed:

3x Average yield increase across **all 11 farmers.**

11 / 11
Farmers completed the full programme

9 of 11
Reported their biggest harvest in memory

3 to 5 months
Extra food security beyond prior season

100%
Of farmers want to continue with the programme

Zero
Total crop failures across the programme

Strong
Community contribution fund established

FROM THE FIELD

"We had never seen cobs this size."

-- Farmer, Minna community, after 2024 harvest

Before joining empowerFarmers, this farmer had never used certified hybrid seeds. He planted local saved seed on the same plot every season and accepted the same thin harvest. In 2024 he received SC651 seeds, NPK fertilizer, and a full training programme. By October he had harvested three times what he had ever grown on that land.

Farmers presenting their harvest gift to the team

Minna, Niger State | 2024

FROM THE FIELD

Farmer proudly showing his maize harvest to the empowerFarmers team
Minna, 2024

Farmers presenting their harvest gift to the empowerFarmers team
Minna, 2024

Minna.

Niger State, North-Central Nigeria.

~40%

of Niger State households depend on farming

60-70%

yield gap on land that could produce far more

80%+

of farmers cannot afford quality inputs upfront

2

communities surveyed and ready to begin in 2026

Why Minna?

Strong community leadership
Community heads and leaders actively engaged.

Existing farming knowledge
Farmers know their land. They just need the inputs.

We have been there.
Field visits done. Baseline collected. Farmers ready.

170 km from Abuja.
Close enough to monitor closely every month.

17 - 20 APRIL 2026

We just were there.

We visited Garatu and Taidna. Met with community leaders and several farmers. They told us what they need: quality inputs, cash for labour, tractors, and access to nearby farmland. They are waiting. Baseline data collected. Analysis ongoing.

GARATU

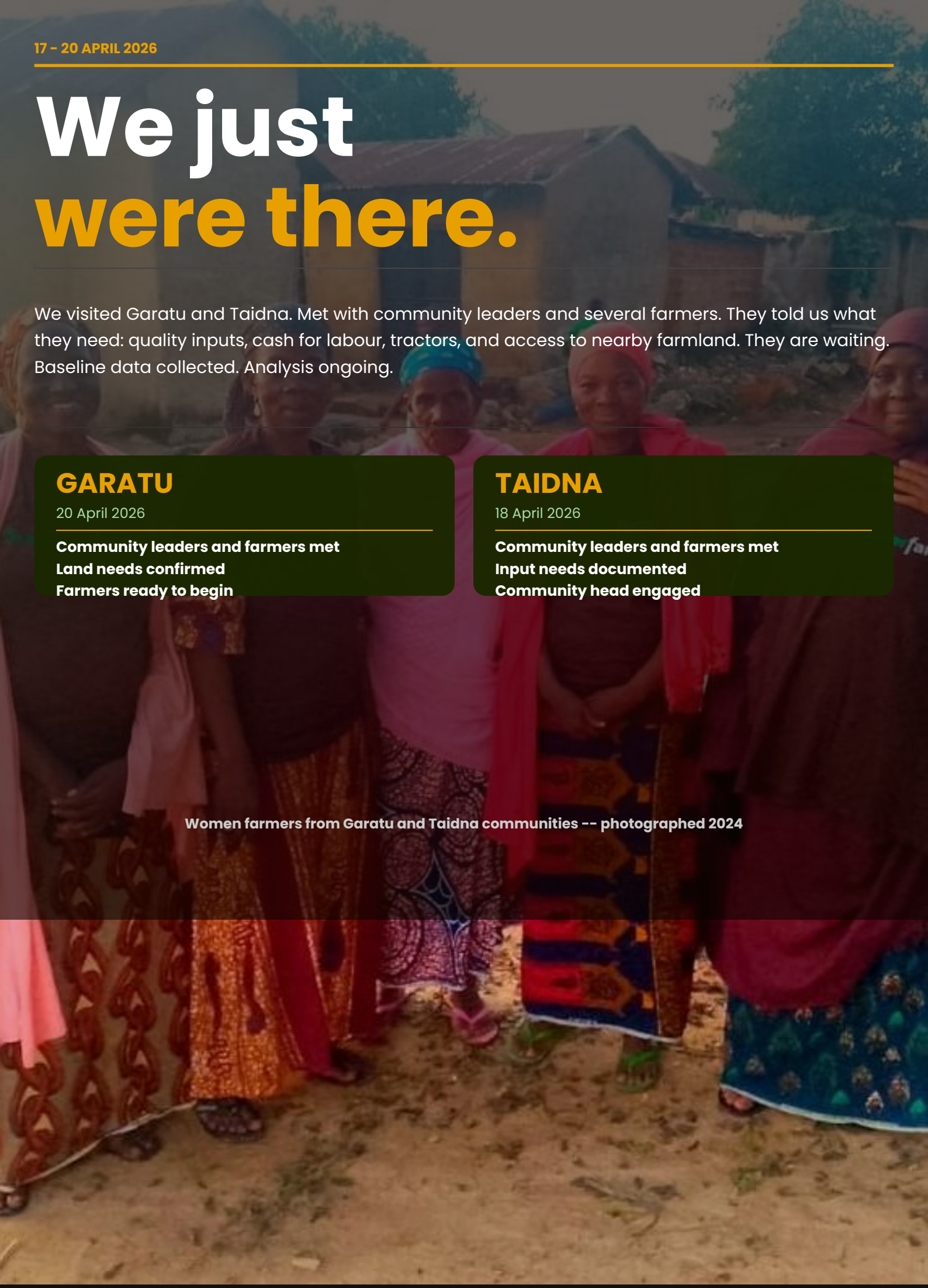
20 April 2026

Community leaders and farmers met
Land needs confirmed
Farmers ready to begin

TAIDNA

18 April 2026

Community leaders and farmers met
Input needs documented
Community head engaged



Women farmers from Garatu and Taidna communities -- photographed 2024

SECTION 05

SUPPORT A FARMER.

The cost, how to contribute, and what you gain

What it costs to change a harvest.

INPUT ITEM	NAIRA	USD
NPK 20-10-10 fertilizer (25 kg x 2)	60,000	$43
Certified maize seeds SC651 (2 kg x 2)	16,200	$12
Lagoon herbicide	16,600	$12
Neem Coated Urea (1 bag, 50 kg)	51,400	$37
Labour cash grant	25,000	$18
TOTAL FOR 1 FULL ACRE	**169,200**	**~$121**

At approx. N1,400 per $1. Confirm prices before procurement.

HALF ACRE

~$60

84,600 Naira

Seeds, NPK, herbicide, urea, cash

FULL ACRE -- RECOMMENDED

~$121

169,200 Naira

Complete package | Maximum impact

empowerFarmers has committed 15 farmers.

85 more spots are open. Anyone can fill one.

2026 GOAL

100 farmers.

One season.

Same land. Better harvests.

Garatu and Taidna communities have been surveyed. Farmers have confirmed participation. The planting window opens in May 2026.

FUNDING PROGRESS **Target: 100 farmers**

15 farmers committed by empowerFarmers **85 more needed from donors**

15	85	~$60
Committed by empowerFarmers	**Still needed** from anyone	**To support** one farmer

HOW TO SUPPORT

Choose your level of impact.

STARTER

Half an Acre

~$60 / 84,600 NGN

Certified seeds, NPK fertilizer, herbicide, and labour cash for one farmer's half-acre plot.

SUPPORT NOW

IMPACT

One Full Acre

~$121 / 169,200 NGN

Complete package -- seeds, two bags NPK, urea top-dressing, herbicide, cash grant, and training.

SUPPORT NOW

PARTNER

Multiple Farmers

Custom amount

2, 5, 10 or more farmers. Individuals, groups, friends -- anyone who wants to do more.

SUPPORT NOW

How to get started

Farmer-to-farmer, capital, or partnership -- under 3 minutes.

empowerlocals.org/support

WHAT YOU GAIN

Real impact.
Real connection.

Direct Farmer Communication

Communicate directly with the farmer you support via WhatsApp or phone. Receive updates, photos, and harvest reports through our field team.

Access to All Reports

Receive the full baseline survey, monthly monitoring reports, endline survey, and harvest data for every farmer you support.

Potential Land Access

Long-term supporters can explore access to farmland in Minna through our community partnerships -- for personal farming or investment.

Direct Harvest Procurement

Liaise with your farmer to purchase maize and other produce at a fair, transparent, below-market price direct from source.

Food Security Contribution

Your support directly reduces hunger in a rural Nigerian family and strengthens community food resilience for years beyond the pilot.

Named Recognition

Corporate and major donors receive named recognition in all programme publications, final reports, and community acknowledgements.

The people behind the harvest.

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An initiative of Empowerment for Local People Foundation

www.empowerlocals.org

@empowerfarmers

A farmer is waiting.

The planting season opens May 2026.

Your support today means a farmer plants on time.

SUPPORT A FARMER NOW

empowerlocals.org/support

Takes under 3 minutes

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100 farmers.
One season.